

Gate B — the drift hunt

All 39 anchors on one contact sheet, read left to right, twice. Fixing a jump here costs an image; fixing it after Gate C costs a shot. Work the list with a pencil — an unticked line is an open gate.

- ☐ Face — any identity whose features moved between neighbouring anchors
- ☐ Costume — damage marks, seam-light, robe construction identical across joins
- ☐ Light — key direction agrees with the movement's plate in every frame
- ☐ Grade — no warm tone anywhere in Movement II; island only warms at golden hour
- ☐ Shared joins — F11, F12, F17 read correctly as the END of one shot and the START of the next
- ☐ Match pairs — F09/F10 and F22/F23 agree on shape, scale and colour
- ☐ Bridges — B01 and B02 go genuinely near-black; 70% obscured reads as a failed hide

Gate C — the timing lock

Cut the stills reel, watch all five minutes without stopping, then freeze. Note the timecode of every reach-for-the-phone moment before deciding anything.

BLOCK	TARGET	ACTUAL	NOTE
Movement I	80s	<i>actual</i> _____	five shots, first cut at 0:48
Movement II	118s	<i>actual</i> _____	generated in strict sequence — the chain is the shot
Movement III	102s	<i>actual</i> _____	locked-off witness; the only push is the last

Cost table, after this gate: re-order two shots ≈ 2 images before · ≈ 80 generations after. Insert ≈ 3 before · ≈ 120 after. The lock is the last cheap moment — date closed _____